Oh RATS! Inspiration Concept Doc

1. HeroQuest

HeroQuest Info

HeroQuest is a fantasy dungeon crawling board game in which players control heroes exploring dungeons, fighting monsters, finding treasure and completing quests. One player takes on the role of Zargon, the Game Master, while the other players control individual heroes.

The game uses a tiled board, character miniatures, cards, dice, furniture models, doors and other physical components to create an immersive tabletop adventure. Players move through rooms and corridors, encounter enemies and face traps and other obstacles. Different characters have their own characteristics, and the combination of physical components and illustrated materials helps communicate the game's fantasy setting. The game is designed for two to five players and includes multiple quests, with opportunities for players to create their own adventures.





What inspires me:

- The tiled board layout, with rooms connected by corridors.
- Character cards displaying stats, abilities and other useful information.
- Using dice for movement and combat, adding an element of chance.
- Physical miniatures that represent each character on the board.

Application to OH, RATS!:

I want to use a similar tile based layout for the house, with rooms and hallways that players can navigate. Cat and Rat characters will have their own miniatures and character cards, while dice will determine movement and potentially combat outcomes. I also want to design and 3D print my own miniatures and physical game pieces.

2. Root

Root is a strategy board game where different factions have unique abilities, objectives and play styles. Players must make strategic decisions based on their own strengths and the actions of their opponents.



What inspires me:

- Different factions having distinct abilities and strategies.
- Strategic movement and positioning around the board.
- Creating an interesting balance between opposing sides.

Application to OH, RATS!:

The Cats and Rats will have different objectives and approaches to gameplay. The Rats must navigate the house and reach the fridge, while the Cats must prevent them from succeeding. I want each side to have its own advantages and abilities, encouraging players to think strategically rather than simply relying on dice rolls.

3. Mansions of Madness

Mansions of Madness is a board game that combines physical components with a digital companion application. The application helps manage parts of the game, including events, encounters and other gameplay information.



What inspires me:

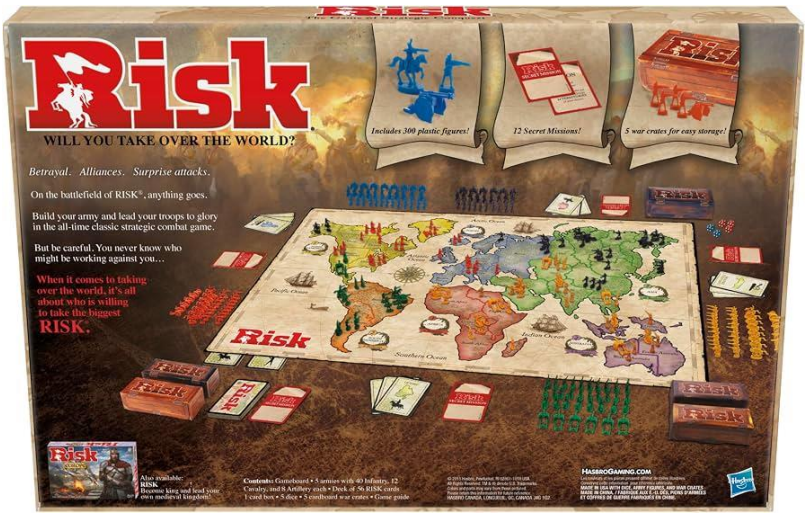
- Combining physical gameplay with digital technology.
- Using an application to manage game information and events.
- Making the digital element support the board game rather than replace it.

Application to OH, RATS!:

I want to develop a digital companion using Svelte and JavaScript. One possible feature is scanning a QR code on a physical trap card to identify it and trigger its effect in the application, such as reducing a Rat's health. I may explore camera-based tracking of physical pieces as a further experiment, depending on technical feasibility and time.

4. Risk

Risk is a strategy board game centred around movement, positioning and controlling areas of a map. Players must consider their routes and make decisions based on their objectives and opponents.



What inspires me:

- Planning routes and anticipating an opponent's movements.
- Making strategic decisions about positioning.
- Balancing offensive and defensive approaches.

Application to OH, RATS!:

The Cats and Rats will need to consider which routes to take through the house. Rats may look for safer or hidden paths towards the kitchen, while Cats must decide where to intercept them and where to place their limited traps. This encourages players to think ahead instead of moving randomly.